ThreatLens Intelligence Bulletin: LockBit 3.0 Ransomware Outbreak with Shadow Deletion

REPORT IDENTIFIER	CLASSIFICATION	THREAT CATEGORY	ASSESSED SEVERITY
TL-ADV-2026-CRIT-004	TLP:AMBER // STRICT	Ransomware	CRITICAL (9.2/10.0)
PUBLICATION DATE	AUTHOR / SOURCE	NLP ENGINE STATUS	VERIFICATION STATE
October 13, 2026	SOC Incident Response	Analyzed (TF-IDF & Rule)	Analyst Confirmed

1. EXECUTIVE INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY

ThreatLens identified an active high-velocity LockBit 3.0 ransomware outbreak impacting corporate workstation endpoints. The adversary gained initial foothold via spearphishing attachment exploiting WinRAR vulnerability CVE-2023-38831. Following ingress, ransomware operators executed 'vssadmin delete shadows /all /quiet' using an obfuscated PowerShell interpreter to inhibit local volume recovery, deployed double-extortion ransom notes (RESTORE-FILES.txt), and initiated encrypted C2 beaconing to 198.51.100.200. Immediate containment protocol and boundary firewall isolation must be enacted.

2. DETAILED FORENSIC INCIDENT NARRATIVE

Security Operations Center sensors detected automated high-rate encryption events across engineering endpoints. Malicious process lockbit_v3.exe was launched via parent process explorer.exe after staging payload dropping with MD5 hash 44d88612fea8a8f36de82e1278abb02f and SHA256 e3b0c44298fc1c149afbf4c8996fb92427ae41e4649b934ca495991b7852b855. Adversaries executed commands to delete Volume Shadow Copies to guarantee irreversible data loss prior to extortion contact. Active command-and-control communication was verified connecting to remote server 198.51.100.200 on port 8080 and leak domain lockbit-leak-portal[.]example[.]org. Negotiation email lockbit-ops[at]decryption-service[.]example was left in dropped ransom notes.

3. EXTRACTED TECHNICAL INDICATORS OF COMPROMISE (6 TOKENS)

INDICATOR (DEFANGED)	TYPE	REPUTATION	CONTEXT / ATTRIBUTION
`198.51.100[.]200`	IPv4	Malicious (C2 Active)	LockBit external C2 communication server
`lockbit-leak-portal[.]example[.]org`	Domain	Suspicious / Extortion	TOR gateway leak portal mirror
`e3b0c44298fc1c149afbf4c8996fb92427ae41e4649b934ca495991b7852b855`	SHA-256	Malicious Payload	LockBit 3.0 encryptor binary
`44d88612fea8a8f36de82e1278abb02f`	MD5	Malicious Dropper	Staging executable dropper hash
`CVE-2023-38831`	CVE	Known Exploited (KEV)	WinRAR code execution vector
`lockbit-ops[at]decryption-service[.]example`	Email	Threat Actor Contact	Operator extortion contact

4. MITRE ATT&CK; ENTERPRISE TAXONOMY CORRELATIONS (5 TECHNIQUES)

TECHNIQUE ID	TECHNIQUE NAME	TACTIC	OBSERVED EVIDENCE ARTIFACT
T1486	Data Encrypted for Impact	Impact	Widespread filesystem encryption with RESTORE-FILES.txt ransom notes.
T1490	Inhibit System Recovery	Impact	Execution of 'vssadmin delete shadows /all /quiet' to destroy volume backups.
T1059.001	PowerShell Execution	Execution	PowerShell -encodedCommand invoked for privilege escalation.
T1071.001	Web Protocols	Command & Control	Encrypted HTTP beaconing to IP 198.51.100.200:8080.
T1567.002	Exfiltration to Cloud Storage	Exfiltration	Staged WinRAR archives transferred to external cloud buckets.

5. ACTIONABLE INCIDENT CONTAINMENT & DEFENSIVE MITIGATION PLAYBOOK

PRIORITY	REMEDIATION ACTION	OPERATIONAL SPECIFICATION
`P0 - URGENT`	**Network Segment Quarantine**	Immediately isolate subnet hosting affected hosts at VLAN boundary to stop lateral propagation.
`P0 - URGENT`	**Edge IP Blocking**	Apply border firewall drop rules for C2 address 198.51.100.200 and DNS sinkhole for lockbit-leak-portal[.]example[.]org.
`P1 - HIGH`	**EDR Hash Hunting**	Execute enterprise-wide EDR sweep for SHA256 e3b0c442... and kill spawned instances.
`P2 - MEDIUM`	**Offline Backup Restoration**	Verify integrity of cold air-gapped immutable backups prior to initiating disaster recovery rebuilds.